



slender
prismatic
crystal



SPODUMENE

Monoclinic • H $6\frac{1}{2}$ –7 • SG 3.1–3.2

This pyroxene mineral is a lithium aluminium silicate. Some enormous crystals have been found; the largest weighed almost 100 tonnes.



prismatic
diopside
crystal

DIOPSIDE

Monoclinic • H $5\frac{1}{2}$ –6 $\frac{1}{2}$ • SG 3.22–3.38

This pyroxene is a generally green-coloured calcium magnesium silicate. It occurs in metamorphic and igneous rocks.



ASTROPHYLLITE

Triclinic • H 3 • SG 3.2–3.4

This complex hydrous silicate of potassium, sodium, iron, and titanium, with fluorine, occurs in gneiss and cavities in igneous rocks.

richterite
crystal



RICHTERITE

Monoclinic
H 5–6 • SG 3.1

The amphibole richterite is a hydrous silicate of sodium, calcium, and magnesium. It occurs in metamorphosed limestones and igneous rocks.



PIGEONITE

Monoclinic
H 6 • SG 3.3–3.46

This brown to purplish black uncommon pyroxene is a magnesium iron calcium silicate. It occurs in igneous rocks and in meteorites.



AUGITE

Monoclinic
H $5\frac{1}{2}$ –6 • SG 3.19–3.56

Augite is a common pyroxene. This silicate of calcium, magnesium, and iron occurs in igneous and metamorphic rocks.

long prismatic
crystal



jadeite

JADEITE

Monoclinic
H 6 • SG 3.25–3.35

One of two carvable materials commonly referred to as jade, this pyroxene mineral is a sodium aluminium iron silicate.

rock groundmass

long, striated
crystals



RIEBECKITE

Monoclinic • H 5 – $5\frac{1}{2}$ • SG 3.26–3.44

This amphibole is a hydrous sodium iron silicate, occurring in igneous rocks. The variety crocidolite, or “blue asbestos”, occurs in metamorphosed ironstone.